concepts of charity were considered ahead of their time, and even today, are considered exceptional in the context of philanthropy', as the Tata Trusts website comments. The Sir Ratan Tata Trust established in 1919 was the first of the Tata Trusts (the JN Tata Endowment, now a part of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust, was not a trust, though it preceded the Sir Ratan Tata Trust in time) followed by others that were created by the Tata family and now in aggregation are called Tata Trusts. The Sir Ratan Tata Trust was begun with a corpus of Rs 80 lakh (approximately equivalent to Rs 468 crore in 2022). The other trusts were created later, including that of Sir Ratan's older brother, Sir Dorabji Tata, in1932 some thirteen years since.

Soon, the Tata family became a beacon for benevolent entrepreneurship. It has influenced other industrial houses too. Sunil Bharti Mittal, chairman of Bharti Enterprise, an Indian conglomerate, says that his organization's 'philanthropy has been inspired by the House of Tatas'. He adds that the profits the Tatas make go primarily to the trusts which are only engaged in social work.

The unwavering commitment of the group's founder, continued by his successors and relatives gave Jamsetji Tata, in 2021, the coveted recognition as the Edelgive Philanthropist of the Century. He was termed as the 'revered' 'super wealth' creator who had distributed his wealth. With donations aggregating $102.4 billion out of a total of $832 billion assessed to have been distributed in the last century, Jamsetji Tata stands tall, having contributed slightly over 37 per cent more than the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, the second largest contributor to philanthropy when the recognition was announced. Ratan, the present chairman of the Trusts, continues the legacy.

The manner in which the Tatas have approached philanthropy has varied from one Tata to another. It also took expression in the myriad welfare schemes implemented by the various Tatas at the helm for more than 150 years in their companies. Consequently, the Tata companies have approached the well-being of its workers and their families as an extension of its commitment to social welfare.

The early introduction of welfare schemes in TISCO for its workers is one such example. In 1920, the company framed rules for compensating accident victims. It was three years later that the central government passed the Workmen Compensation Act. Even so, TISCO did not limit itself to the quantum mandated for accident victims in the act. It compensated workers